THE UNITED REPUBLIC OF TANZANIA

SOKOINE UNIVERSITY OF AGRICULTURE

COLLEGE OF ECONOMICS AND BUSINESS STUDIES (COEBS)

AB CONSULT ▪ PARLIAMENTARY CAPACITY BUILDING INITIATIVE

APPLICATION OF ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE IN PARLIAMENTARY RESEARCH

Day 2 Practical Presentation

Statutory Scrutiny, CAG Audit Ingestion & Parliamentary Questions

Lead Facilitator:	Eng. Dr. Kadeghe Fue, PhD	**Document Ref:**	SUA/COEBS/PARL-AI/DOC-02
Target Cohort:	Parliamentary Researchers & Clerks	**Program Dates:**	Tuesday, 10th November 2026

The Legislative Scrutiny Challenge

Unpacking Complex Amendments Under Tight Committee Deadlines

The Committee Scrutiny Trap

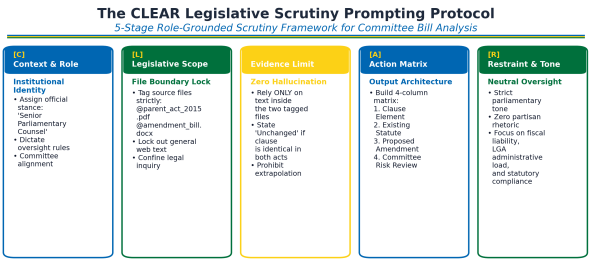
- Government bills often amend **multiple parent acts** simultaneously.
- Minor clauses (e.g., "delete word 'may' and substitute 'shall'") carry massive legal ramifications.
- Committee members receive bills days before scheduled plenary debate.

The AI-Powered Solution

- Ingest both the **Parent Act** and the **Amendment Bill** simultaneously.
- Apply the structured **CLEAR Prompting Framework** to identify concealed legal shifts.
- Extract actionable audit evidence from the Controller and Auditor General (CAG).

The CLEAR Prompting Framework

Guaranteed Clarity, Constraint, and Evidentiary Precision



The 5 CLEAR Pillars

C – Context: Legislative background & mandate.

L – Legislation: Specific section & clause boundaries.

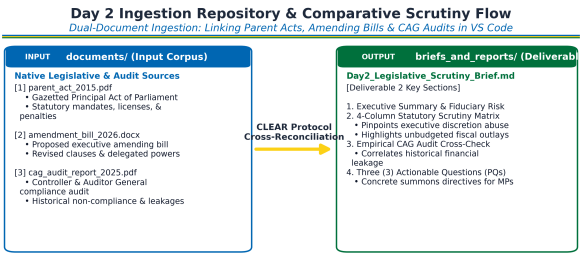
E – Evidence: Ground claims strictly in CAG/NBS text.

A – Actionable: Produce tangible questions for MPs.

R – Red Lines: Zero speculation or policy hallucination.

Statutory Scrutiny Workspace Tree

Dual Document Comparative Workspace Setup



Workspace Organization

- `parent_acts/`: Official consolidated laws of Tanzania.
- `bills/`: New legislative bills gazetted for first reading.
- `cag_reports/`: Annual CAG audit reports for ministries.
- `matrices/`: 4-column statutory comparative matrices.

CAG Audit Ingestion & Discrepancy Tracking

Bridging Statutory Authority with Public Spending Realities

CAG Audit Prompting Strategy

`@cag_reports/CAG_Report_Central_Gov_2025.pdf @bills/Appropriation_Bill_2026.docx`

Context: Standing Committee on Public Accounts (PAC).

Task: Reconcile Vote 48 development expenditure allocations with CAG-reported non-performing procurement contracts.

Output: Table of unresolved audit queries exceeding TZS 500 million, citing the exact CAG page numbers and contract reference IDs.

Benefit: Committee clerks discover hidden fiscal discrepancies in seconds rather than days.

The 4-Column Statutory Scrutiny Matrix

Standardized Legislative Comparison for Standing Committees

Parent Act Clause	Proposed Amendment	Substantive Legal Shift	Actionable Scrutiny Note
Sec 24(1): "Minister may consult Council"	"Minister shall act on binding advice of Board"	Executive discretion curtailed; board veto introduced	Verify board composition and appointment mandate in Schedule 2.
Sec 88(2): "Fine not exceeding 5m TZS"	"Fine not exceeding 50m TZS or 5 yrs jail"	Ten-fold sanction increase; mandatory minimum jail	Scrutinize proportionality against economic offences thresholds.

Formulating Actionable Parliamentary Questions (PQs)

Converting Analytical Scrutiny into Piercing Committee Questions

Weak PQ (Vague / Opinion)

"Why is the government increasing mining penalties when our artisanal miners in Geita are already poor and struggling?"

Flaw: Allows Minister to give evasive, political answer without addressing legal technicalities.

Actionable PQ (Evidence-Grounded)

"In light of Clause 14 raising fines tenfold while CAG Report 2025 (p. 84) shows 68% of mineral disputes remain unadjudicated, what specific appellate recourse is guaranteed to smallholder miners before forfeiture?"

Strength: Cites exact clause and CAG audit facts.